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Italian Meatball Soup with Carrots and Rainbow Swiss Chard

Total Time: 35-45 minutes Calories per Serving: 650

Serves: 2 people

Classic Italian meatballs are universally beloved. They make a flavorful addition to a warm soup with rainbow Swiss chard. This dish takes advantage of the simmer time to blend tastes, textures, and flavors for a satisfying meal.

USDA recommends cooking beef to 160° F.



1. Prepare Ingredients

Preheat broiler to high. Quarter **lemon**. Mince **garlic**. Peel **onion** and cut into small dice. Peel **carrots** and thinly slice crosswise. Rinse **Swiss chard** and thinly slice crosswise, keeping leaves and stems separate. Pat **beef** dry with paper towel.



2. Sauté Vegetables

Heat **1½ tablespoons olive oil** in a medium pot over medium heat. When oil is shimmering, add **garlic** and **onion** and sauté until softened, about 5 minutes. Add as much **crushed red pepper** as desired, **carrots**, and **Swiss chard stems** and sauté until carrots are softening, about 5 minutes.



3. Broil Meatballs

While vegetables sauté, add **beef** to a medium bowl along with **milk**, **breadcrumbs**, **spice mix**, **½ of pecorino**, **½ teaspoon kosher salt**, and **black pepper**. Using your hands, mix well (see Recipe Tip). Divide mixture evenly and form into 6 meatballs, about 2-inches in diameter. Place on a foil-lined baking sheet, transfer to top rack of oven, and broil until browned, about 8 minutes.



4. Simmer Soup

While meatballs broil, add **chicken stock** to pot with vegetables over medium heat and stir to combine. Increase heat to high and bring to a boil, then reduce heat to medium and simmer until flavors are melded, 7-8 minutes. Add **Swiss chard leaves** and cook until wilted, 1-2 minutes.



5. Season Soup

Add **broiled meatballs** to pot with vegetables over medium heat and cook, stirring, until warmed through, about 1 minute. Remove pot from heat. Taste and add **salt** and **pepper** as needed.



6. Plate Soup

Garnish **meatball soup** with **lemon wedges** and **remaining pecorino**, then dig in!

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- RECIPE TIPS

Be sure to read through the entire recipe before you begin cooking.

Hands are great kitchen tools, especially to form perfect meatballs. Incorporate ingredients without crushing them; using your hands prevents over mixing and ensures a softer touch.

- INGREDIENTS

- 1 lemon
- 2 cloves garlic
- 1 yellow onion
- 8 ounces carrots
- 5 ounces rainbow Swiss chard, divided
- 12 ounces ground beef
- ¼ teaspoon crushed red pepper
- 2 tablespoons whole milk
- 2 tablespoons breadcrumbs
- 1 spice mix
  - ½ teaspoon dried basil
  - ¼ teaspoon dried oregano
  - ¼ teaspoon dried parsley
- ¼ cup grated pecorino cheese, divided
- 32 ounces chicken stock

- YOU'LL NEED

- 8" medium pot
- aluminum foil
- baking sheet
- 1½ tablespoons olive oil
- kosher salt
- black pepper

We're proud to be sending you beef that's been raised without antibiotics or added hormones.